OpenSSF TAC Nominees

Candidates:

Daniel Appelquist
Stephen Augustus
Hayden Blauzvern
Hannah Elizabeth Braswell
Katherine Druckman
Sankalp Gilda
Michael Hofer
Georg Kunz
Michael Lieberman
Carlos Tadeu Panato Junior
Alexander Scheel
Yesenia Yser

Daniel Appelquist

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Samsung
GitHub: https://github.com/torgo

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
What do I bring to the TAC table? I bring experience in open source and open standards, with a focus on developer and user needs, the public good, and inclusive governance. Through my work at Samsung, W3C and across the OSS ecosystem, I focus on the needs of the people who build, maintain and use technology. OpenSSF has an important role in making software more secure, while keeping our approach practical, developer-focused and responsive to the wider community.

For the past two years, I have been co-chairing the OpenSSF's Global Cyber Policy Working Group. We have been helping policymakers understand the open source ecosystem and we support OSS projects in responding to regulatory requirements in ways that genuinely improve security. I want to strengthen this connection between policy, engineering and the public interest.

As a member of W3C's Advisory Board, and a participant in C2PA, I advocate for technical governance grounded in real world scenarios and an understanding of the consequences of our decisions. Expect me to ask questions like: "What is the user need?", "Is it in the public good?", "Are we using the right license?", and "How does this help small-scale as well as large-scale projects?"

On the TAC, I will advocate for vendor neutrality, transparent decision-making, collaboration across projects and foundations, and meaningful participation from diverse stakeholders. We should keep asking whether our initiatives solve real problems for developers and maintainers, produce usable outcomes, and make the best use of the OpenSSF community's collective resources. I am also the alternate board representative for Samsung to Akrites and if elected I would seek to ensure alignment between Akrites and OpenSSF.

Stephen Augustus

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Bloomberg
GitHub: https://github.com/justaugustus

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I've served on the OpenSSF TAC since January 2025 and would be honored to be elected to continue this work.

This year, my work has included relaxing the Sandbox entry requirements for newly presented Technical Initiatives and proposing an AI contribution policy for the foundation.

I also work on making our documentation clearer: creating a TAC onboarding guide, clarifying our election processes, documenting roles and responsibilities, and helping staff with pull request submissions.

I co-chair the Supply Chain Integrity Working Group, where we're reworking the charter to better align with Governing Board priorities around maintainer enablement and external engagement.

I sit on darnit's Technical Steering Committee and Scorecard's Steering Committee.

For OpenSSF Scorecard, I'm also a core maintainer. I led its Incubating application and a recent infrastructure migration that supports weekly security scanning of 1.3M+ repositories through external partnerships.

As an elected Governing Board General Member representative, I have consistently carried Technical Initiative needs, like funding, staffing, and infrastructure, directly to the board and brought board context back to maintainers.

If elected, I'll continue to advocate for maintainers and for more secure open source software through OpenSSF initiatives.

You can read more about my work here: https://whois.auggie.dev/

Hayden Blauzvern

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Google
GitHub: https://github.com/Hayden-IO

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC to focus on building practical, widely adoptable supply chain security solutions. My primary work within OpenSSF centers on Sigstore, where I serve as Community Chair and as a core maintainer across Sigstore's services, clients, and public infrastructure. Through developing and operating Sigstore, I have helped support build provenance adoption across major package registries, including npm and PyPI. Beyond Sigstore, I contribute to SLSA and participate in the Securing Software Repositories Working Group. I also frequently speak at OpenSSF and industry conferences to share practical lessons from this work and connect with the broader open source community. Outside of OpenSSF, I lead Google's Open Source Vulnerability Rewards Panel, giving me a firsthand view of real-world vulnerability trends across critical open source software.

Working with TAC members through Sigstore has been a great experience, and I want to give my time back through the TAC to support the broader OpenSSF community. I believe

security should be invisible. We need to build the right standards and tooling to meet developers where they're at. On the TAC, I will focus on supporting low-friction adoption of OpenSSF projects for maintainers and navigating an ever-changing threat landscape driven by AI.

Hannah Elizabeth Braswell

Pronouns: She/Her
Company: Red Hat, LLC
GitHub: https://github.com/hbraswelrh

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
My passion for open source community enablement and advocacy spans the OpenSSF working groups and my active role as the Gemara project's community manager, contributor, and project maintainer. I focus on external engagement and activity across the Linux Foundation to strengthen the project and its relationship with interoperable tools (e.g., Orbit working group tools). I am also in the process of gaining a core maintainer position. As part of the inaugural cohort of OpenSSF Ambassadors, I believe I can expand my reach within open source security communities as a Community TAC Representative, sharing my technical expertise and community guidance.

Katherine Druckman

Pronouns: She/Her
Company: JetBrains
GitHub: https://github.com/kdruckman

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I want to serve on the TAC to help OpenSSF's technical work reach the developers who need it, as AI coding agents change how software gets written and shipped.
Since 2022, my OpenSSF work has connected our Technical Initiatives with the people who use them. I helped establish and lead the DevRel Community, giving ambassadors and maintainers shared language and editorial strategy for presenting OpenSSF projects. I co-chaired the Marketing Advisory Council, coordinated messaging for Scorecard and SBOM adoption, served as a Governing Board alternate, and received OpenSSF's Golden Egg Award. I've presented our projects at SOSS Fusion, OpenSSF Community Day, Grace Hopper and All Things Open. This year I co-hosted practitioner feedback sessions on SLSA,

SBOMs and Scorecard with fellow community members and helped bring the findings back to the community.
I also work where OpenSSF meets AI security. At Intel, I mapped overlapping AI security efforts so new work went to real gaps, reducing duplication of effort. Today I contribute to the Agentic AI Foundation's Security and Privacy working group, which overlaps with our AI/ML Security WG, and I would help the two groups coordinate.
I'm a former software engineer and open source maintainer, and I built my project's CI/CD pipeline. On the TAC, I would make adoption a central factor in how initiatives are prioritized, and push each initiative to focus clearly on who it serves.

Sankalp Gilda

Pronouns:
Company: Deep Thought Solutions
GitHub: https://github.com/astrogilda

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
AI agents now write code, open pull requests and call other tools, and the open source supply chain is starting to rely on the records they leave behind: provenance, approvals, scan results. Most of those records are trusted because some field somewhere says so. I want OpenSSF to make them checkable independently, and the TAC is where that can become a shared expectation across all our projects.

The principle is simple enough: any project that publishes a claim should publish the cases that would refute it, and run them in CI. I have tested this publicly. agent-evidence-vectors 0.24.0 ships 2,030 vectors in 38 corpora, each rejecting case paired with the conformant case it differs from, plus a GitHub Action that runs them in another project's CI. Three outside verifiers pin a corpus in their CI.

In the Global Cyber Policy WG I wrote the first contribution to its response on the EU Cloud and AI Development Act and one of the two contributions on ENISA's draft advisory on AI-assisted development.

On the TAC I would turn that principle into decisions: AI-readiness (#601) shipped as tests an agent can run, scan results (#661) recorded so a reviewer can re-run them, and funding requests (#345) that name a measurable result and its check.

Michael Hofer

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Adfinis
GitHub: https://github.com/karras

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I am applying to serve on the TAC to bring a balanced perspective grounded in both community leadership and hands-on industry expertise.

As the OpenBao TSC Chair, I am deeply committed to growing vendor-neutral communities and strengthening connections across projects and organizations. I look forward to bringing this passion for collaboration to the TAC.

In my role as CTO at Adfinis, an international open source service integrator (founded 25+ years ago, 150+ colleagues), I bridge the gap between open source communities and enterprise needs. By helping organizations implement and maintain open source solutions safely, I gain daily insight into the real-world cybersecurity challenges and operational hurdles faced by mid-sized and enterprise organizations.

By uniting community leadership with practical, end-user perspectives, I hope to humbly serve the TAC and support its overall mission. Thanks YOU for your service! 🤝

Georg Kunz

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Ericsson
GitHub: https://github.com/gkunz/

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I am a director in Ericsson's Open Source Program Office and a member of the OpenSSF technical community since 2022. During this time, I have participated in various technical initiatives, committees and working groups, such as the Best Practices WG, the ORBIT Launchpad SIG, and the Global Cyber Policy Working Group. Recently, I got involved in Akrites as a sister project to the OpenSSF as well.

In the context of the Best Practices WG, I have facilitated the creation of two SIGs: the C/C++ Compiler Options Hardening Guide and the Python Secure Coding Guide. I am also a regular speaker at OpenSSF Community Days as well as other Linux Foundation events, where I talk about the OpenSSF and its initiatives. Since end of 2024 I am co-chairing the Best Practices WG, and I have served two consecutive 1-year terms on the OpenSSF TAC in 2025 and 2026.

I'd like to continue my commitment to the OpenSSF community and serve for another term on the TAC. In this role, I will be focusing 2027 on one of the key challenges of the OpenSSF: fostering the adoption of its tools and methods by both upstream maintainers as well as downstream users, such as OSPOs. With the EU Cyber Resilience Act finally enter fully into force during December 2027, OpenSSF tooling will be fundamentally important for CRA compliance.

Michael Lieberman

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: Kusari
GitHub: https://github.com/mlieberman85

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I've served on the TAC for the last few years, and have been still heavily involved in OpenSSF in my roles as Governing Board member, SLSA maintainer and steering committee member, Darnit maintainer, and I was Supply Chain Integrity WG Co-Chair for most of the year. I have also participated in multiple initiatives and given multiple talks throughout the year on OpenSSF topics.

I am still dedicated to helping the OpenSSF and broader open source community.

Carlos Tadeu Panato Junior

Pronouns:
Company: Chainguard
GitHub: https://github.com/cpanato

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I am deeply committed to advancing open source security through active technical contributions, primarily within the Sigstore and Scorecard projects. My work on Sigstore

has focused on making software supply chain security accessible and practical for all developers, contributing to a project that has fundamentally changed how we approach code signing and verification in the open source ecosystem.
Through my contributions to Scorecard, I've helped organizations assess and improve their security postures by providing actionable insights into repository security practices. This work directly addresses one of the most critical challenges in open source: making security best practices measurable and achievable.
I want to amplify the voices of individual contributors who are driving OpenSSF's technical initiatives forward. My hands-on experience with these projects has given me insight into both the challenges contributors face and the opportunities for broader community engagement. I understand the importance of balancing technical excellence with practical adoption, and I've seen firsthand how the right tools and standards can transform security practices across the ecosystem.
I believe the Security Community needs representation from those actively building the solutions we advocate for. My continued technical involvement ensures I remain grounded in the real-world challenges and innovations happening across OpenSSF projects. I'm committed to fostering collaboration, supporting emerging contributors, and ensuring that individual voices shape the strategic direction of open source security.
I'm ready to serve and advocate for our community's technical contributors.

Alexander Scheel

Pronouns: He/Him
Company: ControlPlane
GitHub: https://github.com/cipherboy

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
The OpenSSF has been a great home for the OpenBao project and I'm excited to contribute more through TAC service.

I've spent the last three years building the OpenBao community post-fork, including bringing it to the OpenSSF from LF Edge last year. I've supported the OpenSSF at OSS NA & EU, published OpenSSF blogs, and highlighted the OpenSSF's work on social media. Before it disbanded, I participated in many Security Tooling calls on behalf of OpenBao and have interfaced with other WGs as well.

I think OpenBao is representative of a project of a size and complexity that translates well to OpenSSF TAC work. OpenBao is organized into a TSC (which I've spent most of my time serving, either as Chair or a member) and several workstreams (many of which I'm fortunate to serve on or chair). As such I lead many of its meetings and have helped navigate many transitions for the project. Of these, moving from LF Edge to OpenSSF was the most complex: I connected with many LF staff members and TAC members during the move to ultimately find a better aligned home.

I believe the depth of my experience in the OpenSSF community will provide some useful insights to help guide my time on TAC.

Lastly, I'm appreciative of Adrianne Marcum and Stacey Potter for inviting me to apply and Georg Kunz and Stephen Augustus for their encouragement and guidance on TAC responsibilities.

Yesenia Yser

Pronouns:
Company: Microsoft
GitHub: https://github.com/Cyber-JiuJiteria

Why do you want to serve on the OpenSSF TAC?
I've been part of OpenSSF for several years, advocating for its projects and mission and helping grow its community. Serving on the TAC would let me deepen that commitment: working more closely across all of our Technical Initiatives, contributing my expertise and perspective to help them grow their impact, and helping make open source more secure and sustainable.

My current roles keep me close to the work. I co-lead the BEAR Working Group, support the growth of the OpenSSF Africa SIG, co-host the "What's in the SOSS?" podcast, and serve as a leader in Alpha-Omega's Security Engineer in Residence program. As a TAC member, I would bring what I learn from these communities to the table and help extend OpenSSF's impact across the open source ecosystem.